



CONTROLLED ENTERPRISE DOCUMENT

TBT-31.01 | Trenching And Excavation

MH Construction, INC Enterprise Management System

Document family: TOOLBOX TALK LIBRARY

Document title: TBT-31.01 | Trenching And Excavation

Version: 1.0 | Lifecycle: Rough Draft

Use only after required functional, technical, field-usability, and approval gates are complete.

Control: Version 1.0 | Status Rough Draft | Author and Chief Editor: Matt Ramsey | Co-Editor: Todd Shoeff | Final Approver: Jeremy Thamert

TBT-31.01: Trenching & Excavation

CSI Division: Div 31 | OSHA Reference: 29 CFR 1926.651
Delivery: Mandatory before any worker enters an excavation 5 feet or deeper.

DIRECTIVE — Policy Standard

All trenches 5 feet or deeper must be protected by an adequate protective system (sloping, shoring, or shielding) before worker entry.

GENERAL ORDER — Procedure

A Competent Person must inspect the trench daily, before each shift, and after any hazard-increasing event (e.g., rainstorm). Spoils must be kept at least 2 feet from the edge of the excavation.

Key Hazards & Mitigation (The 'What If'):

- Changing Conditions: If it rains overnight, the trench is no longer safe to enter until the Competent Person re-inspects it and signs off.
- Equipment Proximity: If an excavator is working near the trench edge, the vibration can cause a cave-in. Keep heavy equipment away from the edge or ensure the shoring is engineered for the surcharge load.
- Egress: If a trench is 4 feet or deeper, a ladder or ramp must be located within 25 feet of lateral travel for all workers.

FIELD INSTRUCTION — Execution

FIELD INSTRUCTION: Foremen must verify the daily trench inspection has been completed by the Competent Person before allowing crew entry. Log attendance on MISH-F-10.1 and complete MISH-F-25.1.

Attendance Roster (Log on MISH-F-10.1):

Print Name	Signature	Company/Trade